Conclusion

> A nation cannot suffer, it cannot feel pain, it cannot feel fear, it has no consciousness… civilians suffer, but the nation cannot suffer...
>
> It's not such a good idea to cause suffering to real entities in the service of fictional stories.
>
> – *Yuval Noah Harari, author of* Sapiens

India's 2016 demonetization evokes strong feelings, both amongst its critics and its supporters.

When asked my views, during the roller-coaster demonetization period, I summarized them as follows:

> Every Indian will agree with the stated objectives of demonetization, namely, removing black money and corruption and tackling fake notes and terrorism.
>
> Only time will tell whether demonetization was the correct policy to achieve these objectives.
>
> Personally, I do not believe it was.
>
> But there can be no disagreement that the 2016 demonetization was extremely poorly executed, causing untold hardship to millions across the India especially the poorest.
>
> I believe it will set the Indian economy back and has also shaken the faith of the common man in the banking system and the RBI – our central bank.[1]

The economic data, and views of the majority of economists, in the period since demonetization seem to support these views.